

The Public location blocks certain programs and services from running, to help protect your computer. If you are connected to a Public place and Windows Firewall is turned on, some programs or services might ask you to unblock them in order to work properly. When you unblock a program, Windows Firewall unblocks it for every network tagged with the same location-type. For example, if you identify an airport terminal as Public and then enable an instant messenger to run on that Public network, Vista will enable IM access to all Public networks.

8.1.1 To Change A Network Location Type

If your computer is part of a domain, you won't be able to change the network location type because it is controlled by your network administrator.

1. Log on to the network

2. Go to **Start > Control Panel > Network and Internet > Network Sharing Center**

3. Click "Customize" next to the network you wish to change, and then click either Public (for "Public place" networks) or Private (for "Home" or "Work" networks)

4. Click Next, and then click Close



Customising network settings

Just after all the network locations are listed, the Networking and Sharing Center will display the "Sharing and Discovery" settings of your computer. Note that these settings are dependant upon your firewall settings and, more specifically, on how you have identified your network to Windows—either Private or Public. The various options available here are: